



TERMS OF REFERENCE (TOR)

Consultancy services for developing a digital youth employment services portal using innovative technology for the Youth Employability Services (YES) center

Introduction

Within the bigger umbrella of Stemming Irregular Migration in Northern & Central Ethiopia (SINCE) program, ILO has been implementing a project on ‘Addressing the Root Causes of Migration in Ethiopia’ in collaboration with the Government of Ethiopia, managed by the Embassy of Italy in Addis Ababa and funded by the European Union Trust Fund for Africa. SINCE was developed with the overall objective to contribute to reducing irregular migration from Northern and Central Ethiopia by improving the living conditions of the most vulnerable populations, including potential migrants and returnees, with specific focus on youth and women.

The findings of the ILO Amhara Regional Socio-Economic Assessment (SEA) have shown that urban unemployment rate is 18.32% and female unemployment is higher than males in the region (10.52% for men and 26.12% for women). Youth unemployment continues to be a challenge in the region although there are active economic investments including mega projects like rail ways, constructions companies, sugar plantations etc., and the SMEs that are expected to generate huge employment opportunities.

As a response, ILO has initiated a pilot youth employability services (YES) center in Bahir Dar in the Amhara region in partnership with the respective regional line bureaus. The pilot YES center was launched in June 2018 and has started the registration of job seekers and vacancies and will also offer provision of various employability skills services for young men and women. Moving forward, the registration of job seekers and vacancies will continue including the job matching. However, ILO would like to have a system that would increase the efficiency and efficacy of the job matching exercise.

In line with this, ILO would like to contract a consultant to develop a digital youth employment services platform using innovative technology that will allow effective flow of information

between employers and job seekers. The key functionality of the platform will be inclusive of the following;

- A labor market exchange that will enable job seekers to post their curriculum vitae and employers to post vacancies.
- Online labor exchange nodal center (job matching).
- Relevant services for both employers and job seekers.
- The developed model will be a pilot that has the potential for scale and replication to other similar centers.
- The consultant will also train the YES center staff to effectively use this online platform.

Purpose of the consultancy:

- The main purpose of the assignment is to develop and set up a user friendly digital platform in English language that will provide efficient and quick quality services to job seekers and employers.
- It will enable job seekers to post their curriculum vitae and employers to post vacancies.
- It will be searchable by key search criteria for both job seekers and employers.
- Online Labor Exchange Nodal Centre (jobs matching)
- Relevant services for both employers and job seekers such as but not restricted to offering information on employability skills requirements and inputs to develop those, announcements about apprenticeships/training programs, tips on writing resumes etc.

Users:

Employment counselors in the YES centre should be able to use the system off-line. It is administered by the YES centre. Employers and jobseekers wanting to upload CVs or vacancies need to register, and fill in a standardized form.

Functions:

- Entry of job vacancies and job-seeker information needs to be simple and follow a standard format.
- Entries need to be reviewable and printable before being submitted.
- All entries need to be easily printable.

- Search among vacancies and among jobseekers needs to be simple, either by keywords or by key categories.
- All entries need to have an automatic expiry date with a prior alert to the person who entered the information.
- Interested people should be able to register for a newsletter/alert function once new vacancies or announcements come up.

Expected tasks of the consultant:

- Conduct a field assessment to understand the local conditions of the region, including internet availability, smart phone use, and internet access which will also determine the choice of the operating system for the mobile applications.
- Prepare an inception report on the design, functions and implementation steps for the digital YES portal and discuss it with the ILO and relevant project partners.
- Prepare a test version of the platform and mobile application.
- Pilot test the test version with a group of potential users and make adjustments.
- Prepare the final version of the platform and mobile application.
- Prepare a manual on the use and application of the digital platform for employment counselors.
- Conduct training for YES center staff on the use and access of the digital platform and the related web based and mobile applications.

Expected Deliverables:

- Inception report on the design and implementation of the digital YES portal.
- Test version of the digital YES portal (including web-based and mobile application).
- Final version of the digital YES portal (including web-based and mobile application).
- Manual on the use and application of the digital platform.
- Final report including the design of the digital platform, tested and operational system.

Duration:

- The duration of the consultancy will be 25 working days, across the timeline of 15th December 2018-14th March 2019.
- Within 10 days of signing the contract, the consultant will present the inception report.

- The field assessment will take place in January 2019, followed by the development of the draft report and the training of the YES centre staff.
- Final report and final version of the digital platform along with its products tested and operational will be submitted by the end of 3 months of signing the contract.

Required qualifications and experience:

- A minimum of 7 years of professional work experience in developing information technology solutions, digital platforms, web based and mobile applications and innovative technology designs.
- The applicant/ team leader would have an educational background in software development, computer engineering and /or information technology.
- Demonstrated expertise of working with social and/or business enterprises in developing innovative technological solutions for development issues.
- Portfolio of work demonstrating innovative technological solutions/models developed internationally.
- Demonstrated international work experience especially in countries out of Ethiopia would be considered an advantage.

Application:

- Interested applicants should submit their technical and financial proposal as well as any supporting documents to addis_procurement@ilo.org or in hard copy to the ILO-CO Addis Ababa registry.
- Along with the technical and financial proposal, the applicant should enclose a portfolio of previous works undertaken in developing IT solutions for development issues.
- Deadline for submitting applications: 25 November 2018.